J&HK Extras

Up our sleeve

Everything worth doing that is not in the day plans, by area. Places to eat and drink, the food to try, and things to swap in if the plan moves or something is missed. When a place goes into the itinerary it leaves this list, and when one comes out it lands back here.

渋谷 Shibuya

With Harajuku, Omotesando, Daikanyama and Ebisu.

In the itinerary: Sat 17 Sun 18 Mon 19 Tue 20

MUST TRY HERE

Tonkatsu	Thick pork cutlet in crisp panko, with shredded cabbage and a sweet, fruity sauce.	Try it: Tonkatsu Maisen Aoyama
Gyukatsu	Rare crumbed beef cutlet you sear yourself, piece by piece, on a hot stone.	Try it: Gyukatsu Motomura Harajuku
Yuzu shio ramen	A clear salt and chicken broth lifted with yuzu citrus, Tokyo's lighter style of ramen.	Try it: AFURI Harajuku
Nigiri at the counter	Sushi handed straight from the chef, eaten in one bite within seconds of being made.	Try it: Sushi Tokyo Ten Shibuya
Yakitori	Skewers of every part of the chicken, grilled over charcoal, best with a cold beer.	Try it: Nonbei Yokochō
Japanese whisky highball	Whisky and very fizzy soda over ice, the drink of every Tokyo bar and izakaya.	Try it: JBS (Jazz, Blues, Soul)

EAT

1.5 hrs	Path ¥¥ Walk-in Famous Dutch pancake breakfast in Tomigaya	**FITS** Sun 18 slow breakfast. It is about 15 minutes' walk from the hotel and on the way to Meiji Jingū through Yoyogi Park. Go at 08:00 rather than 09:00 to beat the queue.
45 min	Fuglen Tokyo ¥ Walk-in Norwegian coffee and mid century chairs in Tomigaya	**FITS** Mon 19 late breakfast. Open from 07:00 every day including Monday, when Path is closed, and an easy 15 minute walk from the hotel.
1 hr	Tonkatsu Maisen Aoyama ¥¥ Walk-in Tabelog 3.43 Classic tonkatsu in an old Omotesando bathhouse	**FITS** Sat 17 lunch in Omotesando. It is two minutes off the avenue, open all afternoon, and a filling first proper meal after the flight.
45 min	AFURI Harajuku ¥ Walk-in Light, citrusy yuzu ramen near Harajuku	**FITS** Sun 18 lunch in Harajuku. A quick, light bowl between Meiji Jingū and the festival streets. It is a few minutes north of Takeshita Street.
1 hr incl. queue	Gyukatsu Motomura Harajuku ¥ Walk-in Rare beef cutlet you finish on a hot stone	**FITS** Mon 19 lunch in Omotesando at 14:00. After the lunch rush the queue is shortest, and it is a short walk from the vintage stores.

40 min	Uogashi Nihon-ichi Dogenzaka ¥ Walk-in Standing sushi counter, piece by piece	**FITS** Sat 17 dinner close to the hotel if you would rather not book: quick, cheap and ten minutes' walk. Also a good snack stop any evening.
40 min	Uobei Shibuya Dōgenzaka Cheap, fast touch-screen sushi.	**FITS** A quick lunch or a late bite. Five minutes from the Hachikō exit.
45 min	Shogun Burger Shibuya ¥¥ Walk-in Tabelog 3.26 Proper wagyu burger, five minutes from the hotel	**FITS** Sat 17 dinner if jet lag wins: five minutes' walk, open late, no booking. Or any late night after a big day.
1 to 2 hrs	Shibuya Yokochō Regional food counters under the hotel.	**FITS** An easy dinner any night back at the hotel, or after a late arrival.
2 hrs	Kaikaya by the Sea ¥¥ Book now Fun surf-shack seafood izakaya in Shibuya	**FITS** Sat 17 dinner close by: a cheerful first night about 12 minutes' walk from the hotel. Book an 18:30 table.
1.5 hrs	Sushi Tokyo Ten Shibuya ¥¥¥ Book now Omakase sushi counter, about 20 courses	**FITS** Sun 18 nice dinner, the other sushi option to Sushi Hatsume in the day plan. Ten minutes' walk from the hotel, away from the festival crowds. Book a 19:00 or 19:30 seat.
1.5 hrs	Ebisu Yokochō Cash Tiny izakaya under one roof.	**FITS** Dinner on a free evening. Sun 18 after Street Kart, or Tue 20 if back early.
DRINK		
1 hr	The SG Club ¥¥ Walk-in Award winning cocktails, 8 minutes from Shibuya	**FITS** A nightcap after Sun 18 nice dinner, or any evening. It is a short walk from the hotel.
1 hr	CÉ LA VI Tokyo ¥¥¥ Book Rooftop cocktails above the Scramble	**FITS** Sat 17 after dinner if you have energy left, for a second look at the lights after Shibuya Sky. Or a drink before Sun 18 nice dinner.
1 hr	Bar Trench ¥¥ Walk-in Eight seat absinthe speakeasy in Ebisu	**FITS** Pairs with an Ebisu Yokochō night, five minutes' walk apart. Not on a set slot, but a strong option for Sun 18 after dinner.
1 hr	JBS (Jazz, Blues, Soul) ¥ Walk-in Cash Tiny vinyl listening bar, 10,000 records	**FITS** Sat 17 after dinner near Dōgenzaka. Low key and quiet, ideal for a first jet lagged night.
VIEWS		
45 min	Magnet by Shibuya109 rooftop ¥1,800 Card only The Scramble Crossing from above, drink in hand.	**FITS** Best at dusk or after dark. Fits any Shibuya evening, three minutes from the crossing.
20 min	Shibuya Hikarie Sky Lobby Free Free window view of the crossing and the trains.	**FITS** Any time to midnight. Pairs with a walk past the station.
SHOPPING		
1 to 2 hrs	Shibuya Parco Nintendo Tokyo and the Pokémon Center on 6F.	**FITS** While Cynthia shops Omotesando. Also in How-to 10 in the itinerary.

1 hr	Harakado New design building, rooftop and Kosugi-yu bathhouse.	**FITS** Opposite Tokyu Plaza. Fits Sat 17 or Mon 19 around Omotesando.
30 min	Tokyu Plaza Omotesando Free Mirror escalator and a free rooftop terrace.	**FITS** At the Harajuku crossing. Five minutes from Takeshita Street on Sun 18.
1 hr	Ura-Harajuku Back-street labels, sneakers and vintage.	**FITS** Either side of Cat Street, so it slots into Sat 17 morning.
45 min	Tower Records Shibuya Nine floors of music, freshly renovated.	**FITS** Five minutes from the hotel. Good for a wet hour.

FURTHER OUT

Half day	Daikanyama and T-Site Design shops and the T-Site bookshop.	**FITS** A swap for Sun 18 morning instead of Meiji Jingū. Pairs with Nakameguro.
2 hrs	Nakameguro and the Starbucks Roastery Canal-side boutiques and the Roastery.	**FITS** With Daikanyama, or a slow coffee morning on its own.
45 min	Yoyogi Park Free Lawns, ginkgo and the Sunday rockabilly dancers.	**FITS** Next door to Meiji Jingū. Add it to Sun 18 after the shrine.

MASSAGE

1.5 hrs	The Head Spa Tokyo Harajuku Book Head spa, English spoken.	**FITS** Five minutes from the hotel. Book ahead.
1.5 hrs	Head Spa Josho Book Head spa in the Omotesando back streets.	**FITS** Open to 22:00, so it works after dinner. Book ahead.
1 hr	Body Spa Sora Body and foot massage, east side of the station.	**FITS** 10:00 to 23:00.
1 hr	Joyful Massage Spa Shibuya Body and foot massage in Dōgenzaka.	**FITS** Open 24 hours. Walk-ins usually fine.

新宿 Shinjuku

East and west Shinjuku, Kabukichō, Golden Gai, Shinjuku-sanchōme, Nishi-Shinjuku and Shin-Ōkubo.

In the itinerary: Mon 19

GOOD TO KNOW

Shinjuku Gyoen is closed on Mondays, so it only fits a swap day, and its gates close at 16:00 in October. Both Tocho decks are open on Mon 19. Fūunji and BenFiddich close on Sundays, fine for Monday. Takano Fruit Parlour hours are from 2022, so check on the day. Nothing here needs booking this week: book Kakiden or a New York Bar window seat only if you want them.

MUST TRY HERE

Tsukemen	Thick cold noodles dipped into a rich, concentrated hot broth.	Try it: Fūunji
Tempura	Prawns, fish and vegetables in a whisper of batter, straight from the oil.	Try it: Tempura Tsunahachi Shinjuku
Niboshi ramen	Ramen built on dried sardines: bold, briny and very Tokyo.	Try it: Niboshi Ramen Nagi Golden Gai
Fruit parfait	Japan's prized fruit layered in a tall glass with cream and ice cream.	Try it: Takano Fruit Parlour
Kaiseki	A seasonal procession of small, exquisite courses.	Try it: Kakiden
Depachika sweets	Wagashi and pastries boxed like jewellery in the department store basement.	Try it: Isetan food hall

EAT

45 min incl. queue	Fūunji ¥ Walk-in Tokyo's favourite tsukemen, near the south exit	**FITS** Mon 19 at 17:00 when it reopens, as a filling start before Omoide Yokochō. Open Mondays, closed Sundays.
1 hr	Tempura Tsunahachi Shinjuku ¥¥ Walk-in Tempura counter in sesame oil since the 1920s	**FITS** Mon 19 dinner instead of grazing at Omoide. On the east side near Shinjuku-sanchōme, so it suits the walk from Kabukichō towards Golden Gai.
30 min	Niboshi Ramen Nagi Golden Gai ¥ Walk-in Intense sardine ramen up a Golden Gai stair	**FITS** Mon 19 at 21:00, a late bowl in Golden Gai before the Fukutoshin line home. Open all night.
45 min	Takano Fruit Parlour ¥¥ Walk-in Fruit parfaits under Shinjuku's luxury fruit shop	**FITS** Mon 19 at 16:45 after the 3D cat, three minutes away. Or dessert after dinner, last orders 20:30.
45 min	Isetan food hall Free Tokyo's grandest depachika food hall	**FITS** Mon 19 at 16:45, beside Shinjuku-sanchōme, for sweets and a snack before the evening. Also a rainy day stop.
2 hrs	Kakiden ¥¥¥ Book Kyoto kaiseki courses by the east exit	**FITS** Mon 19 special dinner at 18:00 in place of Omoide, then Kabukichō and Golden Gai after. Last orders 20:00.

DRINK

1 hr	Bar BenFiddich ¥¥¥ Walk-in World famous farm-to-glass cocktail counter	**FITS** Mon 19 nightcap after Golden Gai, 15 minutes' walk west. Open to 02:00 and Monday is a quiet night. Taxi home after the trains.

1 hr	New York Bar ¥¥¥ Book 52nd floor jazz bar from Lost in Translation	**FITS** Mon 19 at 17:00 for sunset (about 17:00) instead of the 3D cat, then down to Omoide. Arrive before 20:00 to skip the music charge.
VIEWS		
45 min	Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Free Free deck 202 metres up in west Shinjuku	**FITS** Mon 19 at 16:15 for dusk, leaving the hotel at 15:45. Both decks are open that day. Then ten minutes' walk to Omoide Yokochō for 17:30.
SIGHTS		
2 hrs	Shinjuku Gyoen Formal gardens and lawns by Shinjuku	**FITS** Closed Mondays, so not on Mon 19. Works as a swap for Sun 18 morning instead of Meiji Jingū. Closes 16:00 in October.
SHOPPING		
1 hr	Beams Japan Five floors of Japanese craft and labels	**FITS** Mon 19 at 16:45 if you come early, five minutes from the 3D cat. Closes 20:00.
NIGHT		
20 min	Tokyo Night and Light Free Free projection show on the Tocho towers	**FITS** Mon 19 at 18:00, pairs with the deck: leave Omoide at 17:45, watch, then head east to Kabukichō by 18:45.
1.5 hrs	Thermae-yu ¥¥ Big hot spring bath in Kabukichō	**FITS** Mon 19 late, a soak after Golden Gai. Open all night, but the late surcharge applies, so earlier is cheaper.
FURTHER OUT		
2 hrs	Shin-Ōkubo Koreatown: K-pop, skincare, street food	**FITS** One stop on the Yamanote. Mon 19 at 15:30 instead of resting at the hotel, then walk down to Shinjuku for 16:45.

横浜 Yokohama and Kamakura

Minato Mirai, Chinatown, Yamashita Park, Motomachi and the Yamate Bluff, with Kamakura further out.

In the itinerary: Tue 20

GOOD TO KNOW

The Cup Noodles Museum in Minato Mirai is closed on Tuesdays, so it is left out. The Manyo Club rooftop footbath is in the day plan as an idea: ask first, see How-to 22 in the itinerary in the itinerary. Weekday Chinatown kitchens close early: Jukeihanten last orders 20:00, Edosei shuts 19:30, which suits the 19:30 train. Manchinrō and Heichinrō have irregular closed days, so check the Tuesday when booking. In Kamakura the Buddha and Hase-dera close at 17:00, so a Kamakura swap needs to reach Kamakura by about 11:30.

MUST TRY HERE

Nikuman	A giant steamed pork bun, the Chinatown street snack.	Try it: Edosei Chinatown
Spaghetti Napolitan	Ketchup spaghetti with ham and peppers, a Yokohama hotel invention.	Try it: The Café, Hotel New Grand
Pudding à la mode	Crème caramel dressed with fruit and cream, born at the same hotel.	Try it: The Café, Hotel New Grand
Mapo tofu	Silky tofu in a numbing, chilli bean sauce.	Try it: Jukeihanten
Peking duck	Crisp lacquered skin rolled in thin pancakes, the banquet centrepiece.	Try it: Heichinrō
Shirasu-don	Tiny local whitebait piled on rice, Kamakura's signature dish.	Try it: Komachi-dōri

EAT

1 hr	The Café, Hotel New Grand ¥¥ Walk-in Napolitan and pudding à la mode, where both began	**FITS** Tue 20 lunch at 13:00, facing Yamashita Park, so the afternoon walk into Chinatown starts at the door.
1 hr	Yokohama Hammerhead ¥¥ Walk-in Waterfront pier of open kitchen restaurants	**FITS** Tue 20 lunch at 13:00 if you would rather stay in Minato Mirai, 12 minutes from the Red Brick Warehouses.
15 min	Edosei Chinatown ¥ Walk-in Chinatown's giant pork buns, eaten on the street	**FITS** Tue 20 afternoon as you reach Chinatown, a snack before dinner. Closes 19:30 on weekdays.
1.5 hrs	Jukeihanten ¥¥ Walk-in Sichuan mapo tofu and hot pot	**FITS** Tue 20 Chinatown dinner at 17:30, the relaxed choice. Weekday last orders 20:00.
1.5 hrs	Heichinrō ¥¥¥ Japan's oldest Chinese restaurant, Cantonese	**FITS** Tue 20 Chinatown dinner at 17:30, on the main street. Good for Peking duck and dim sum.
2 hrs	Manchinrō ¥¥¥ Book Grand Cantonese banquet, Chinatown since the 1890s	**FITS** Tue 20 special dinner at 17:30. The ¥11,000 course is the sweet spot. Book a table this month.

DRINK

45 min	Bar Sea Guardian II ¥¥ Walk-in Classic British bar in the 1927 New Grand	**FITS** Tue 20 at 17:00, a pre-dinner cocktail five minutes from Chinatown.
1 hr	Sky Lounge Sirius ¥¥¥ Book 70th floor lounge over the harbour	**FITS** Only if you flip Tue 20: Chinatown for lunch, then Minato Mirai at dusk with a drink here from 17:30.

VIEWS

30 min	Ōsanbashi Pier rooftop **Free** Free wave-shaped deck facing the skyline	**FITS** Tue 20 afternoon, on the harbour walk between Red Brick and Yamashita Park. Back after dinner for the night view.
45 min	Sky Garden, Landmark Tower **¥** 69th floor deck over the port	**FITS** Tue 20 at 11:30, beside Sakuragichō as you arrive, before the Air Cabin. Fuji on a clear morning.
30 min	Yokohama Marine Tower **¥** Lattice tower deck at the end of Yamashita Park	**FITS** Tue 20 at 19:00 after dinner, a minute from the station, then the 19:30 train. Night tickets from 18:00.
30 min	Kishamichi promenade and Unga Park **Free** Free waterfront walk facing the Ferris wheel	**FITS** Tue 20 free afternoon, or at dusk from about 16:30 when the wheel lights up. Right by the Air Cabin.
15 min	Cosmo Clock 21 **¥** Ride the Ferris wheel over the harbour	**FITS** Tue 20 free afternoon, five minutes from the Air Cabin. Open Tuesdays, closed Thursdays.

SIGHTS

1.5 hrs	Yamate Bluff and Harbor View Park **Free** Old foreign hilltop: houses, cemetery, harbour view	**FITS** Tue 20 at 15:30, up from Yamashita Park, then down through Motomachi into Chinatown. Houses close 17:00.
1 hr	Nippon Maru and Yokohama Port Museum **¥** 1930 sailing ship you can walk through	**FITS** Tue 20 straight after the Air Cabin, beside Sakuragichō. Open Tuesdays, last entry 16:30.
45 min	Hikawa Maru **¥** **Cash** Art deco ocean liner at Yamashita Park	**FITS** Tue 20 on the harbour walk, before Chinatown. Doors close 16:30, so go before the dusk walk.

SHOPPING

45 min	Motomachi Shopping Street Old fashioned boutique street below the Bluff	**FITS** Tue 20 at 16:30, on the way down from Yamate to Chinatown dinner.

FURTHER OUT

Half day	Kamakura Samurai capital: temples, shrine, Great Buddha	**FITS** Dropped from Tue 20, but it could replace Minato Mirai: Tsukiji, then Kamakura from about 11:30, then the JR Yokosuka line to Yokohama for Chinatown dinner.
45 min	Great Buddha of Kamakura **¥** The 13th century bronze Buddha, in the open	**FITS** Part of a Kamakura swap on Tue 20. Open 08:00 to 17:00 in October, ¥300, plus ¥50 to go inside.
1 hr	Hase-dera **¥** Hillside temple with a sea view terrace	**FITS** Five minutes from the Great Buddha, so pair them. 08:00 to 17:00, last entry 16:30, ¥400.
20 min	Enoden **¥** Little seaside train between the sights	**FITS** Kamakura Station to Hase, three stops, for the Buddha and Hase-dera. Suica works.
45 min	Tsurugaoka Hachimangū **Free** Kamakura's great shrine up the stone steps	**FITS** Ten minutes' walk from Kamakura Station. Grounds 06:00 to 20:00, free.

45 min	Komachi-dōri ¥ Snack and sweet lane to the shrine	**FITS** Between Kamakura Station and Hachimangū, so it is lunch on the way: shirasu and street snacks.

AFTER DARK

1.5 hrs	Daikoku PA car meet, from the Yokohama day ¥¥ Taxi Japan's famous car meet car park, by taxi, hire car or tour	**FITS** Tue 20 after the Chinatown dinner: a licensed taxi from about 19:00 instead of the 19:30 train, an hour at the meet on a quieter weeknight, then back to Yokohama Station by about 21:00 for the train home. Or hire a car for the Yokohama day. The tour from the hotel stays the Sun 25 option (How-to 23 in the itinerary).

京都 Kyoto

With Pontochō and Kiyamachi, Gion and Higashiyama, Arashiyama, Kyoto Station and Fushimi.

In the itinerary: Wed 21 Fri 23 Sat 24

GOOD TO KNOW

Book the Fri 23 Gion dinner this week: Endo Yasaka on TableCheck is the strongest pick, Nakatani is the cheaper kaiseki (closed Sundays only). Menami is closed Wednesdays, so it only fits if you swap the two dinners. Daiichi Asahi is closed Thursdays, no clash. Bee's Knees is closed Sundays, Kagizen Mondays, no clash. Jidai Matsuri, Kyoto's big costume parade, is on Thu 22 from about 12:00 (Imperial Palace to Heian Shrine), and the Kurama Fire Festival is that night: no clash while you are in Osaka, but if you swap Thursday and Friday, expect crowds and road closures in the centre. Hours for eX café, Yudofu Sagano, Sake Bar Yoramu, K36 and the temples were not all confirmed for 2026: check Google Maps the day before.

MUST TRY HERE

Kaiseki	Kyoto's formal seasonal dinner of many small courses, the city's great food tradition.	Try it: Gion Shimbashi Nakatani
Yudofu	Silky tofu simmered at the table in kelp broth, made with Kyoto's soft water.	Try it: Yudofu Sagano
Obanzai	Kyoto home cooking: small plates of simmered vegetables, yuba and fish.	Try it: Kyoto Izakaya Ponto
Matcha sweets	Uji matcha with warabi mochi or kuzukiri in black sugar syrup.	Try it: Kagizen Yoshifusa
Kyoto-style ramen	Clear soy and pork broth, thin noodles and a pile of Kujō green onion.	Try it: Honke Daiichi Asahi
Yatsuhashi	Kyoto's signature sweet: soft cinnamon rice dough folded around red bean paste.	Try it: Sannenzaka and Ninenzaka
Fushimi sake	Soft, smooth sake from the city's own brewing district, best as a tasting flight.	Try it: Sake Bar Yoramu

EAT

20 min	% Arabica Arashiyama ¥ Walk-in Latte on the river by Togetsukyō bridge	**FITS** Fri 23 coffee at 10:15. A few minutes' walk from the bridge and the river path. Take it to the bank, as there is almost no seating.
45 min	eX café Arashiyama ¥¥ Walk-in Toast-your-own warabi mochi and matcha	**FITS** Fri 23 at 10:15 if you want to sit down rather than queue for coffee. Near Tenryū-ji and the station.
1 hr	Yudofu Sagano ¥¥ Walk-in Tofu hotpot set in a garden house	**FITS** Fri 23 early lunch at 11:00 in Arashiyama instead of Nishiki, if the morning runs long. Skip the market and go straight to the rest at the hotel.
1.5 hrs	Kyoto Izakaya Ponto ¥¥ Walk-in Kyoto small plates on the Pontochō alley	**FITS** Wed 21 casual dinner at 19:00. Right on Pontochō, two minutes from Shijō Bridge. Graze on obanzai and yakitori.
45 min	Gyoza ChaoChao Sanjō Kiyamachi ¥ Walk-in Kyoto's most famous gyoza, on Kiyamachi	**FITS** Wed 21 dinner if Pontochō looks full or pricey. Open from 17:00 to 02:00 on a Wednesday, so it also works as a late bite.
1.5 hrs	Oryori Menami ¥¥ Walk-in Obanzai counter since 1939, Bib Gourmand	**FITS** Closed Wednesday, so it only works if you swap the dinners and eat in Gion on Wednesday. Then it is Fri 23 at 17:30 on Kiyamachi.

45 min incl. queue	Honke Daiichi Asahi ¥ Walk-in Classic Kyoto shoyu ramen by the station	**FITS** Sat 24 at 10:45 after check-out, instead of an ekiben. Five minutes from Kyoto Station, quick turnover. Be out by 11:30 for the 12:01.
40 min	Kagizen Yoshifusa ¥ Walk-in Kuzukiri and matcha in a Gion tea room	**FITS** Fri 23 at about 17:30 on the way down into Gion, if you skip the pagoda drink. On Shijō-dōri, two minutes from Yasaka Shrine.
2 hrs	Tempura Endo Yasaka ¥¥¥ Book now Course tempura in a Gion teahouse	**FITS** Fri 23 special dinner at 18:30. Five minutes' walk from Yasaka Pagoda, so it follows the sunset perfectly. The ¥16,000 Rokuhara course keeps it inside budget.
2 hrs	Gion Shimbashi Nakatani ¥¥¥ Book now Seasonal kaiseki by the Shirakawa canal	**FITS** Fri 23 special dinner at 18:30. The classic Kyoto kaiseki at the gentle end of the budget, in the prettiest lanes of Gion.
2 hrs	Gion Matsumuro ¥¥¥ Book now Quiet Kyoto dinner course in north Gion	**FITS** Fri 23 special dinner at 18:30, if Endo and Nakatani are full. Near the top of your budget.

DRINK

45 min	K36 The Bar and Rooftop ¥¥¥ Walk-in Rooftop drink level with Yasaka Pagoda	**FITS** Fri 23 at 17:15, straight after the pagoda at sunset. Then five minutes downhill to an 18:30 dinner at Endo.
1 hr	Bee's Knees ¥¥ Walk-in Asia's 50 Best speakeasy behind a bookshelf	**FITS** Wed 21 after Pontochō dinner, about ten minutes' walk north. Or Fri 23 after Gion. Closed Sundays.
1 hr	L'Escamoteur ¥¥ Walk-in Magician-themed cocktails with swing seats	**FITS** Wed 21 nightcap from 20:00, a few minutes from Pontochō and Kiyamachi.
1 hr	Sake Bar Yoramu ¥¥ Walk-in Tiny sake bar with tasting flights in English	**FITS** Wed 21 after dinner, a short taxi north of Pontochō. Check it is open that night first.

SIGHTS

45 min	Sanjūsangen-dō ¥ 1,001 golden Kannon statues in one hall	**FITS** Fri 23 at 14:30, cutting the rest short. Then a five minute taxi up to Kiyomizu-dera for 15:30. Closes 17:00.
45 min	Kōdai-ji ¥ Zen gardens and a bamboo grove off Ninenzaka	**FITS** Fri 23 at about 16:45, between Ninenzaka and the pagoda. Last entry is about 17:00, so go straight there off the steps.
45 min	Kennin-ji ¥ Twin dragon ceiling behind the Gion teahouses	**FITS** Fri 23 if you swap Kiyomizu for a slower Gion afternoon. Two minutes from Endo, closes 17:00.
30 min	Higashi Hongan-ji Free Giant wooden hall on the walk to the station	**FITS** Sat 24 at 10:30 on the walk from the hotel to Kyoto Station, right on Karasuma-dōri. Or Fri 23 in the rest window.
1 hr	Ginkaku-ji ¥ The Silver Pavilion and its sand garden	**FITS** The northern Higashiyama half day. Fri 23 at 13:15 instead of resting, then the path south and a taxi to Kiyomizu at 15:30. Closes 17:00.
45 min	Philosopher's Path Free Canal-side path linking the eastern temples	**FITS** Walk it south from Ginkaku-ji, past Hōnen-in, to Nanzen-ji. About 30 minutes without stops.

20 min	Hōnen-in **Free** Thatched gate and sand mounds, rarely busy	**FITS** Five minutes off the Philosopher's Path. Grounds are free and close at 16:00.
45 min	Nanzen-ji **Free** Huge gate and a red brick aqueduct	**FITS** The south end of the Philosopher's Path. Taxi from here to Kiyomizu-dera is about ten minutes.

FURTHER OUT

Half day	Uji Matcha town and the Phoenix Hall	**FITS** A swap for the Fri 23 Arashiyama morning if the bamboo grove fails you, or if Thursday and Friday get reshuffled. 20 minutes on the JR Nara line.
1.5 hrs	Fushimi sake district **¥** Sake warehouses and a tasting, south of Inari	**FITS** Sat 24 only if you come down the mountain by 09:00 and ask for an 11:00 check-out. Two stops on the Keihan line from Inari.

MASSAGE

1 hr	YUMEMISHI Shijō-Karasuma Body and foot massage, closest to the hotel	**FITS** Fri 23 in the 12:45 rest window, a few minutes from Nishiki. Opens 12:00.
1 hr	Kyoto Relaxation Massage Hannari Body massage beside Nishiki Market	**FITS** Fri 23 straight after Nishiki lunch, or Wed 21 late, open to 22:00.
1.5 hrs	Head Spa Salon QUATRE Kyoto **Book** Head spa near Shijō-Karasuma	**FITS** Fri 23 in the rest window. One subway stop from the hotel. Book ahead.
1.5 hrs	The Head Spa Tokyo Kyoto **Book** Head spa at Shijō-Kawaramachi	**FITS** Fri 23 after Nishiki, at the east end of the arcades. Closes 19:00. Book ahead.

奈良 Nara

Nara Park, Sanjō-dōri and the old Naramachi quarter.

In the itinerary: Wed 21

GOOD TO KNOW

Isuien is closed Tuesdays, so Wed 21 is fine. Kōfuku-ji is only passed in the plan, so the National Treasure Museum is listed as the add-on, not the temple itself. Naramachi shops and the Kōshi-no-ie close around 17:00. Hours for Mentoan, Mizuya Chaya, Harushika and Yoshikien were not confirmed for 2026: check Google Maps the night before.

MUST TRY HERE

Kakinoha sushi	Cured mackerel or salmon on pressed rice, wrapped in a persimmon leaf.	Try it: Kakinoha sushi
Yomogi mochi	Mugwort rice cake pounded at speed in front of you, filled with red bean.	Try it: Nakatanidō
Kinchaku kitsune udon	Udon hidden inside a fried tofu pouch tied up like a purse.	Try it: Mentoan
Narazuke	Vegetables pickled for months in sake lees, dark, sweet and boozy.	Try it: Sanjō-dōri
Nara sake	Nara calls itself the birthplace of refined sake. Taste five at the brewery.	Try it: Harushika sake brewery

EAT

40 min	Mentoan ¥ Walk-in Udon tucked inside a fried tofu purse	**FITS** Wed 21 lunch at 12:00 if you would rather sit down than grab kakinoha. Ten minutes south of Sanjō-dōri, so it costs you about 15 minutes overall.
20 min	Mizuya Chaya ¥ Cash Thatched teahouse in the woods	**FITS** Wed 21 at about 14:15, right on your walk from Kasuga Taisha to Tōdai-ji. Matcha and a sweet under the trees.

DRINK

30 min	Harushika sake brewery ¥ Walk-in Five sake tasting at a Naramachi brewery	**FITS** Wed 21 only if you do Naramachi instead of Nigatsu-dō. Daytime only.

SIGHTS

40 min	Kōfuku-ji National Treasure Museum ¥ Ashura and Kōfuku-ji's great statues	**FITS** Wed 21 at 12:45 as you pass Kōfuku-ji, if lunch is quick. The pagoda is wrapped, but the museum is open.
45 min	Isuien garden ¥¥ Stroll garden that borrows Tōdai-ji's roof	**FITS** Wed 21 at 15:30 instead of Nigatsu-dō, five minutes west of the Nandaimon gate. Closed Tuesdays, so Wednesday is fine. Last entry about 16:00.
30 min	Yoshikien garden Free Moss and pond gardens, free with a passport	**FITS** Next door to Isuien, so add it on Wed 21 at about 16:00. Bring passports.
1 hr	Naramachi Free Old merchant lanes south of the park	**FITS** Wed 21 as a swap for the Tōdai-ji hill if the day runs late: ten minutes south of Kōfuku-ji, and a short walk to JR Nara for the train.
20 min	Naramachi Kōshi-no-ie Free Walk through a restored townhouse	**FITS** In Naramachi, with Harushika and Mentoan. Closed Mondays, open Wednesday.

SHOPPING

20 min	Yu Nakagawa (Nakagawa Masashichi) Nara linen and tea towels since 1716	**FITS** In Naramachi. Good small gifts if you do the old town.

FURTHER OUT

Half day	Hōryū-ji ¥¥ The world's oldest wooden buildings	**FITS** Not on this trip's Nara afternoon. It is a separate half day, about 15 minutes by JR from Nara plus a 20 minute walk, and only works if you drop Osaka or Arashiyama.

Osaka

大阪

Day trip from Kyoto: Osaka Castle, Umeda, Kuromon, Horie, Namba, Shinsekai, Dōtonbori and Hōzenji Yokochō.

In the itinerary: Thu 22

GOOD TO KNOW

Thursday closures on Thu 22: Yaekatsu, the best known kushikatsu counter in Janjan-Yokochō, is closed on Thursdays, so use Tengu in the same alley or Daruma under the tower. Okonomiyaki Mizuno may also be closed on Thursdays (sources disagree), so check Google Maps that morning and fall back to Fukutarō. Okazu Izakaya Kuu, a small sake izakaya by Hōzenji, is also closed Thursdays. Thu 22 is Shitennō-ji flea market day (21st and 22nd each month). Nothing needs booking this week; Kani Dōraku is the only place worth booking, and only if you want a sit-down dinner. The HEP Five Ferris wheel in Umeda was closed for works from October 2025, so it is left out. Kuromon stalls wind down from about 16:00 and like cash.

MUST TRY HERE

Takoyaki	Octopus in a molten dashi batter ball, crisp outside, far too hot to eat straight away.	Try it: Takoyaki Wanaka Sennichimae
Okonomiyaki	A cabbage and batter pancake cooked on the griddle in front of you, with sweet sauce and mayonnaise.	Try it: Okonomiyaki Mizuno
Negiyaki	Okonomiyaki's lighter cousin, packed with spring onion and finished with soy and lemon.	Try it: Fukutarō
Kushikatsu	Crumbed, deep fried skewers dipped once in a shared pot of thin sauce. Never twice.	Try it: Kushikatsu Daruma Shinsekai Sōhonten
Kitsune udon	Osaka's own udon, in a clear dashi with sweet simmered fried tofu on top.	Try it: Dōtonbori Imai
551 Hōrai butaman	A big, soft steamed pork bun, the snack every Osakan brings home.	Try it: 551 Hōrai

EAT

20 min	R Baker Osaka Castle Park ¥ Walk-in Rice flour bakery inside the castle park	**FITS** Thu 22 takeaway breakfast at 08:30. Open from 07:00, so buy curry bread and coffee and eat on a bench below the walls.
15 min	551 Hōrai ¥ Walk-in Osaka's famous steamed pork bun	**FITS** Thu 22: grab a hot butaman on the walk from Kuromon or before Dōtonbori at 18:30. Or buy a box at Osaka Station for the train home.
40 min	Maguroya Kurogin ¥¥ Walk-in Kuromon's tuna specialist, eat at the counter	**FITS** Thu 22 Kuromon lunch at 12:00. Make this the first stop: a fatty tuna and seared belly plate, then graze on from there.
30 min	Kuromon Sanpei ¥¥ Walk-in Uni, oysters and sushi with somewhere to sit	**FITS** Thu 22 Kuromon lunch, second stop. The eat-in area is a welcome seat after the morning on your feet.
30 min	Usamitei Matsubaya ¥ Walk-in Where kitsune udon was invented, 1893	**FITS** Thu 22 during the Shinsaibashi run around 14:00, as a light second lunch. Open Thursday, closed Sundays.
30 min	Kushikatsu Daruma Shinsekai Sōhonten ¥ Walk-in The original kushikatsu, under Tsūtenkaku	**FITS** Thu 22 Shinsekai snack at dusk, about 17:00. Open all day, so a quick plate of five skewers and a beer, then on to Dōtonbori.
30 min	Tengu ¥ Walk-in Locals' kushikatsu counter in Janjan-Yokochō	**FITS** Thu 22 Shinsekai snack on the way in at 16:15. Open Thursday. Yaekatsu next door is closed on Thursdays.

20 min	Takoyaki Wanaka Sennichimae ¥ Walk-in The best takoyaki in Namba, crisp and molten	**FITS** Thu 22 Dōtonbori eat standing up from 18:30. Five minutes south of the canal. Kukuru on Ebisu bridge, under the giant octopus, is the photo-friendly backup.
1 hr	Fukutarō ¥ Walk-in Negiyaki and okonomiyaki, loud and local	**FITS** Thu 22 dinner from 18:30. Opens 17:00 on weekdays, five minutes from Dōtonbori. Put your name down first, then wander for takoyaki while you wait.
1 hr incl. queue	Okonomiyaki Mizuno ¥ Walk-in Dōtonbori's classic okonomiyaki since 1945	**FITS** Thu 22 dinner at 18:30 if open: one listing says it closes on Thursdays, so check Google Maps that morning. Fukutarō is the safe swap.
40 min	Dōtonbori Imai ¥ Walk-in Kitsune udon in a calm old udon house	**FITS** Thu 22 on Dōtonbori around 18:30 if you want to sit down for ten minutes of quiet. Last orders 20:00.
15 min	Rikurō Ojisan no Mise ¥ Walk-in Wobbly cheesecake, warm from the oven	**FITS** Thu 22 between Namba Yasaka and Shinsekai, or after Dōtonbori. Five minutes from Namba Station, open to 20:00.
20 min	Hōzenji Meoto Zenzai ¥ Walk-in Red bean soup for two beside the mossy statue	**FITS** Thu 22 Hōzenji Yokochō at 20:30, as dessert before the quiet drink. Open to 22:00.
1.5 hrs	Kani Dōraku Dōtonbori Honten ¥¥¥ Book Crab feast under the giant moving crab	**FITS** Thu 22 dinner at 18:30 if you would rather sit down than graze. Right on Dōtonbori. Book a table online this week.
DRINK		
1 hr	Mizukake Chaya ¥ Walk-in Robata grill and sake in Hōzenji Yokochō	**FITS** Thu 22 quiet drink at 20:30, a few steps from Mizukake Fudō. Sake and a skewer or two before the train.
1 hr	Bar36, Swissôtel Nankai Osaka ¥¥¥ Walk-in 36th floor cocktails over the Namba neon	**FITS** Thu 22 after Hōzenji, on top of Namba Station, so it is on the way to the Midōsuji line home. Open to 23:30 on Thursdays.
1 hr	Craftroom ¥¥ Walk-in Asia's 50 Best cocktail bar, ten seats	**FITS** Thu 22 nightcap on the way home: five minutes from Osaka Station, before the JR special rapid to Kyoto. Open Thursday, closed Sundays.
1 hr	Bar Nayuta ¥¥ Walk-in No menu, drinks made to your taste	**FITS** Thu 22 after Hōzenji if you are happy to catch a later train. Ten minutes' walk to Amerikamura, open to 03:00.
VIEWS		
1 hr	Abeno Harukas 300 ¥¥ Osaka's highest deck, 300 metres up	**FITS** The weather fallback for Thu 22: if Umeda Sky was clouded out, go at sunset, ten minutes' walk from Shinsekai. 09:00 to 22:00, about ¥2,000.
SIGHTS		
1 hr	Shitennō-ji Free Cash Flea market day: Thu 22 is market day	**FITS** Thu 22 swap for part of the Horie shopping: the monthly market runs on the 22nd, and the temple is 15 minutes' walk from Shinsekai. Go before 16:00.
SHOPPING		
45 min	Sennichimae Doguyasuji Knives, takoyaki pans and plastic food	**FITS** Thu 22 straight after Kuromon lunch: it runs between the market and Namba, so it costs almost no extra walking.

45 min	Pokémon Center and Nintendo Osaka **Free** Pokémon Center and Nintendo store, one floor	**FITS** Thu 22 near Umeda Sky in the morning, or on the way home, above Osaka Station. Open to 20:00.
NIGHT		
1 to 2 hrs	Ura Namba **Walk-in** Back-street izakaya and standing bars	**FITS** Thu 22 instead of Hōzenji if you want more noise, not less. Five minutes east of Namba Station.
FURTHER OUT		
2 hrs	Nakazakichō and Nakanoshima **Free** Old wooden-house cafés and a river island	**FITS** Dropped from Thu 22. If the castle runs short, Nakazakichō is ten minutes' walk from Umeda Sky.
1.5 hrs	Sumiyoshi Taisha **Free** Ancient shrine and the red arched bridge	**FITS** A swap for the Horie shopping on Thu 22. Ten minutes by Nankai local train from Namba. Closes 17:00.
Full day	Universal Studios Japan **¥¥¥** **Book** Super Nintendo World and the big theme park	**FITS** You chose against it, to spend the day in the city. Kept only in case Thu 22 changes completely.

Ginza and east Tokyo

銀座

With Hibiya, Yūrakuchō, Marunouchi, Shimbashi, Tsukiji, Toranomon, Azabudai, Asakusa, Kuramae and Odaiba.

In the itinerary: Tue 20 Sat 24 Sun 25 Mon 26

GOOD TO KNOW

Kabuki-za's October run ends on 20 October, so there is no kabuki on your Ginza days. Star Bar is closed on Mondays and Bar High Five on Sundays: one each night. Book Tempura Yamanoue (TableCheck) or the Sushi Bus (sushi-bus.com) this week if you want either for Sun 25. Tonton and Monja Kondo hours come from older listings, so check Google Maps on the day. The Unicorn Gundam at DiverCity Odaiba came down at the end of August 2026.

MUST TRY HERE

Monjayaki	Tokyo's gooey, griddle-fried batter of cabbage and seafood, scraped off the hotplate with tiny spatulas.	Try it: Monja Kondo, Tsukishima
Tempura at the counter	Each piece fried to order and handed straight across, crisp, light and never greasy.	Try it: Tempura Yamanoue Ginza
Katsu sando	A thick pork cutlet in soft white bread with tonkatsu sauce, the classic Tokyo takeaway.	Try it: Ginza Bairin
Anpan	Ginza's own invention: a soft bun of sweet red bean paste, topped with a salted cherry blossom.	Try it: Ginza Kimuraya
Menchi katsu	A crumbed, deep-fried mince patty, eaten hot in the street in Asakusa.	Try it: Asakusa Menchi
Yakitori under the tracks	Skewers off the charcoal and a cold beer while the trains rumble overhead.	Try it: Yakitori Tonton

EAT

1 hr	Tsukiji Hongwanji Café Tsumugi ¥ Walk-in 18-dish temple breakfast in Tsukiji	**FITS** Sun 25 slow breakfast. Taxi 5 minutes from the hotel, be there by 08:00 at the weekend, then taxi on to the East Gardens. Sotoroku on the hotel's 18F (buffet to 10:00) is the no-effort fallback.
30 min	% Arabica Azabudai Hills ¥ Walk-in Good coffee by Kamiyachō Station	**FITS** Mon 26 after teamLab at about 10:40, if you skip Sky Room or want a coffee for the train. In the basement of Garden Plaza, on your way to Kamiyachō.
20 min	Ginza Kimuraya ¥ Walk-in The bakery that invented anpan, 1874	**FITS** Sun 25 afternoon in Ginza. It is on the 4-chōme crossing beside the Wakō clock tower. Grab a cherry blossom anpan as you pass.
45 min	Ginza Bairin ¥¥ Walk-in Ginza's oldest tonkatsu and a famous katsu sando	**FITS** Sun 25 'eat in the complexes' evening, ten minutes from the hotel. Or Mon 26 after Shimbashi: take away a katsu sando for the 06:22 start to Haneda.
1 hr	Tsunahachi, Matsuya Ginza ¥¥ Walk-in Walk-in tempura on Matsuya's 8F	**FITS** Sun 25 'eat in the complexes' evening. Matsuya's 8F restaurant floor trades to 22:00, well after the shops close, with an English menu.
1.5 hrs	Beer Hall Lion Ginza 7-chōme ¥¥ Walk-in Japan's oldest beer hall, built 1934	**FITS** Sun 25 dinner if you want something louder than a restaurant floor. On Chūō-dōri in 7-chōme, eight minutes' walk back to the hotel.
1.5 hrs	Monja Kondo, Tsukishima ¥ Walk-in Monjayaki on Tsukishima's Monja Street	**FITS** Sun 25 dinner as a change from Ginza. Yūrakuchō line from Ginza-itchōme, two stops, or a 10 minute taxi. Open from 11:30 on Sundays.

1.5 hrs	Tempura Yamanoue Ginza ¥¥¥ Book now Counter tempura course on Ginza Six 13F	**FITS** Sun 25 nice dinner, no extra travel: book an 18:00 counter seat on TableCheck, after the Ginza Six rooftop. Top of your budget, so check the course price when booking.
1 hr 10 min	Sushi Bus ¥¥¥ Book now All-you-can-eat sushi on a double-decker tour	**FITS** Sun 25 evening: the 17:00 or 19:00 departure from Kajibashi car park near Tokyo Station, 15 minutes from Ginza. ¥16,000 each, sushi and drinks included.
45 min	Daikokuya Tempura ¥ Walk-in Cash Classic Asakusa tendon since 1887	**FITS** Mon 26 lunch at about 13:30 after Kappabashi. The queue is shorter after the noon rush. Cash only.
10 min	Asakusa Menchi ¥ Walk-in Hot menchi katsu to eat in the street	**FITS** Mon 26, a snack between Kappabashi and Sensō-ji, or instead of a sit-down lunch. Two minutes from Kaminarimon.
1.5 hrs	Uokin Shimbashi main store ¥¥ Walk-in Big sashimi platters, Shimbashi seafood izakaya	**FITS** Mon 26 Shimbashi dinner at 19:00. A minute from the station, packed on a Monday night. Order the six-kind sashimi platter.
1 hr	Yakitori Tonton ¥ Walk-in Cash Smoky skewers under the Yūrakuchō tracks	**FITS** Mon 26 dinner, ten minutes' walk from Shimbashi along the tracks. Or graze here first, then finish in Shimbashi.

DRINK

1 hr	Star Bar Ginza ¥¥¥ Walk-in Classic Ginza cocktails, the sidecar is the order	**FITS** Sun 25 after dinner. It is closed on Monday, so Sunday is your night for it. Go before 21:00 for a counter seat.
1 hr	Bar High Five ¥¥¥ Walk-in World-famous bar, no menu, made to your taste	**FITS** Mon 26 after the Shimbashi dinner, ten minutes' walk into Ginza. Closed Sundays, so Monday is your night. Arrive soon after 20:00.
1 hr	Peter: the Bar ¥¥¥ Walk-in 24th floor cocktails over Hibiya Park	**FITS** Sun 25 at dusk (sunset about 16:55) instead of the department store rooftops. Opens 15:00 on Sundays, ten minutes from the hotel.

VIEWS

20 min	Caretta Shiodome Sky View Free Free 46th floor view over the bay	**FITS** Any evening on the walk home, five minutes from the hotel. Mon 26 late, a last look at Tokyo lit up before the early flight.

SIGHTS

1 to 1.5 hrs	Hama-rikyū Gardens ¥ Bayside garden with a teahouse on the pond	**FITS** Sun 25 instead of the East Gardens, ten minutes' walk from the hotel. Or Tue 20 straight after the Tsukiji breakfast if you finish early: it opens at 09:00, five minutes away.
45 min	Kuramae and Dandelion Chocolate ¥ Walk-in Bean to bar chocolate in quiet Kuramae	**FITS** Mon 26 between Kappabashi and Sensō-ji, or a dry stop on a wet day. 15 minutes' walk south of Kappabashi.

NIGHT

1 to 2 hrs	Yūrakuchō Cash Izakaya and yakitori in the railway arches	**FITS** Mon 26 19:00 alternative to Shimbashi, ten minutes' walk. Andy's Shin-Hinomoto by exit C1 is the English-friendly start. Mostly cash.

FURTHER OUT

2 hrs	Odaiba **Free** Bayside malls, beach and promenade	**FITS** Sat 24, if check-in is quick, go out at 15:00 rather than 16:00 and walk the Odaiba Seaside Park boardwalk before the fireworks. Note the Unicorn Gundam statue ended its display in August 2026.

MASSAGE

1 to 1.5 hrs	Head Spa ZEN **Book** Late head spa in Ginza 2-chōme	**FITS** Sun 25 after the shops close, before a late dinner. Open to 23:00.
1 to 1.5 hrs	Head Spa zwei HAUS **Book** Head spa in Ginza 1-chōme	**FITS** Sun 25 mid afternoon, a break from the department stores. Open 10:00 to 22:00.
1 hr	Buasai Ginza Thai massage five minutes from the hotel	**FITS** Sat 24 after the fireworks (open to midnight), or Mon 26 after dinner while you pack in your head.
1 hr	YURAGI Late bodywork in Ginza 7-chōme	**FITS** Mon 26 late after Shimbashi, open to midnight. Legs will need it after Asakusa.

日本 Japan other

Experiences, shopping and day trips that are not tied to one area.

In the itinerary:

GOOD TO KNOW

No sumo tournament runs on your dates, so a show is the way to see it. Hirakuza Ginza refunds only 50% within 21 days and nothing within 7 days, so decide this week. Spa LaQua refuses entry with tattoos. Japan's tax-free system changes on 1 November 2026: everything you buy in October uses the current tax-off-at-the-till system. Kakigōri is a summer dish and mostly off menus by late October, so it is left out.

MUST TRY HERE

Tamago sando	A pillowy konbini egg salad sandwich, crusts off, better than it has any right to be.	Try it: Konbini must-tries
Konbini fried chicken	Famichiki or Karaage-kun from the hot case by the till, the perfect late night snack.	Try it: Konbini must-tries
Matcha	Stone-ground green tea, whisked frothy and bitter-sweet, or in parfaits and ice cream.	Try it: Nakamura Tokichi Ginza
Wagashi	Delicate seasonal sweets of bean paste and rice, made to be eaten with matcha.	Try it: Toraya Ginza
Sake	Try a flight of small pours, dry to fruity, then buy the bottle you liked best.	Try it: Hasegawa Saketen, GranSta Tokyo
Japanese whisky	Buy a bottle to take home: Japanese labels cost less here, if you can find them.	Try it: Bic Camera Yūrakuchō

EAT

10 min	Konbini must-tries ¥ Walk-in Egg sando, onigiri and fried chicken	**FITS** Any morning, or Tue 27 breakfast before the 06:22 walk to Shimbashi. There is a konbini on every block.
45 min	Depachika ¥¥ Walk-in Department store food halls, Ginza best	**FITS** Sun 25 while you shop Mitsukoshi and Matsuya, for a tasting lap or a picnic dinner in the room. Mon 26 for gifts to take home.
45 min	Nakamura Tokichi Ginza ¥¥ Walk-in Uji matcha parfaits on Ginza Six 4F	**FITS** Sun 25 afternoon break in Ginza Six, before the rooftop garden. Go before 15:00 or after 18:00 to dodge the queue.
45 min	Toraya Ginza ¥¥ Walk-in Imperial wagashi and matcha in Ginza 7-chōme	**FITS** Sun 25 afternoon, open on your dates. A calmer, more traditional alternative to the matcha parfait.

DRINK

30 min	Hasegawa Saketen, GranSta Tokyo ¥¥ Walk-in Sake tasting bar inside Tokyo Station	**FITS** Sat 24 as you come off the Shinkansen at 14:15, before leaving the gates, if you have energy for a quick glass. Or Sun 25 at Tokyo Station with a platform ticket.

SIGHTS

2 to 2.5 hrs	Sumo show ¥¥¥ Book now Sumo show with dinner in Ginza	**FITS** Sun 25 at 17:00: Hirakuza Ginza, 1-9-13 Ginza, a daily 17:00 show with a kaiseki dinner, from ¥17,000 each on Klook. Or Mon 26 at 11:00 at Tokyo Sumo Club in Tokyo Tower, straight after teamLab.
45 min	Konparu-yu ¥ Walk-in Cash Old Ginza public bath, five minutes away	**FITS** Mon 26 at about 18:00, after Asakusa and before the Shimbashi dinner. Closed Sundays.

SHOPPING

30 min	Gachapon capsule toy shops ¥ Cash Capsule toys, thousands of machines	**FITS** Any Shibuya evening at #C-pla, or Sun 25 at #C-pla premium in Ginza. Bring ¥100 coins.
1 hr	Uniqlo Ginza ¥¥ Twelve-floor Uniqlo flagship	**FITS** Sun 25 in Ginza while Chūō-dōri is car-free. Passports for tax-free.
45 min	Daiso Ginza ¥ Flagship 100 yen shop, souvenirs and snacks	**FITS** Sun 25 in Ginza, same building as Loft. Good for cheap gifts and an extra bag.
1 hr	Ginza Loft ¥¥ Stationery, beauty and clever gadgets	**FITS** Sun 25 in Ginza, same building as Daiso. Loft's beauty floor has a tester bar.
1 hr	Bic Camera Yūrakuchō ¥¥ Electronics, cameras and Japanese whisky	**FITS** Sun 25 on the walk from Tokyo International Forum into Ginza, or Mon 26 evening for whisky to fly home. Tax-free.
5 min	Tax-free shopping Free How to skip the 10% tax	**FITS** Any shopping day. Carry your passport, not a copy, and keep sealed bags sealed until you are out of Japan.

NIGHT

2 to 3 hrs	Spa LaQua ¥¥ Walk-in Real onsen baths at Tokyo Dome City	**FITS** A wet evening, Sun 25 or Mon 26: Marunouchi line direct from Ginza to Kōrakuen, about 12 minutes. Cheaper after 19:00.
1 to 2 hrs	Karaoke Kan Shibuya ¥ Walk-in Lost in Translation karaoke rooms, Shibuya	**FITS** A late night in Shibuya, Sat 17 or Mon 19 after Shinjuku. Close to the hotel in Udagawachō.
30 min	Purikura no Mecca ¥ Walk-in Photo sticker booths, open all night	**FITS** Any Shibuya evening, a minute off Center-gai and close to the hotel. Do it together: couples are fine.

FURTHER OUT

Full day	Hakone Onsen, Lake Ashi and Fuji views	**FITS** Not in the plan. A whole day from Shibuya via Shinjuku, so only if you drop Kamakura and Yokohama.
Full day	Nikkō Gilded shrines and October colour	**FITS** Not in the plan. Tōbu trains leave from Asakusa, so it would replace the Mon 26 Asakusa day.

Hong Kong

香港

Tsim Sha Tsui, Jordan and Yau Ma Tei on the Kowloon side, with Central, SoHo and Sheung Wan across the harbour.

In the itinerary: Tue 27 Wed 28 Thu 29 Fri 30

GOOD TO KNOW

Book this week: the Wed 28 big dinner (Man Wah, Mott 32 or Ho Lee Fook; pre-order the duck at Mott 32), Hutong if you want it for Tue 27, and Spring Moon if that is your Fri 30 yum cha. The Chairman was named Asia's best in 2026 but now opens for lunch only and is very hard to book, so it is not an option for Wed 28 dinner. No Happy Valley races on your dates: Wed 28 is a Sha Tin meeting. Hong Kong Museum of Art is closed on Thursdays, so keep it for Friday. Coa is closed Mondays and Lan Fong Yuen on Sundays, neither of which clashes. Bar Leone and Coa take no bookings, so expect to queue on Wed 28. Hing Kee, Mak Man Kee and the Temple Street stalls are cash only. Some opening hours here come from older listings (Mammy Pancake, Lei Garden at Elements, Hutong): check Google Maps the day before.

MUST TRY HERE

Dim sum	Steamed and fried small bites with tea: har gow, siu mai, char siu bao, ordered off a trolley or a tick sheet.	Try it: Maxim's Palace, City Hall
Roast goose	Crisp, lacquered skin over rich meat, best over rice noodles in broth. The char siu is the other must.	Try it: Yat Lok
Wonton noodles	Thin springy egg noodles and prawn wontons in a small bowl of clear, savoury broth.	Try it: Mak Man Kee
Egg tart	Warm, wobbly egg custard in a crisp pastry shell, Hong Kong's favourite snack.	Try it: Bakehouse
Pineapple bun	A sweet bun with a crackly sugar top, no pineapple in it, split hot with a slab of cold butter.	Try it: Kam Wah Cafe
Hong Kong milk tea	Strong black tea strained through a cloth and mixed with evaporated milk, silky and punchy.	Try it: Lan Fong Yuen
Claypot rice	Rice cooked in a clay pot until a crunchy crust forms, topped with sausage or meats and sweet soy.	Try it: Hing Kee Restaurant
Egg waffle	A hot sheet of crisp edged bubbles, soft inside, eaten straight from the bag.	Try it: Mammy Pancake

EAT

1.5 hrs	Hutong HK$$$ Book now Crispy chilli crab and flaming duck, three minutes away	**FITS** Tue 27 dinner in Tsim Sha Tsui at 20:45, straight off the Avenue of Stars. Book a 21:00 table so you are not rushed after the cruise.
40 min	Mak Man Kee HK$ Walk-in Cash Classic wonton noodles in Jordan, open past midnight	**FITS** Tue 27 dinner if you would rather keep it casual: open to 00:30, no booking, and on the way to Temple Street if you have the energy. Also works Thu 29 before the market.
2 hrs	Man Wah HK$$$ Book now Michelin starred Cantonese, 25 floors above the harbour	**FITS** Wed 28 big dinner at 19:30. A short taxi down from the Peak, and the Mandarin Oriental is a five minute walk from the bars. The pick for views and occasion.
2 hrs	Mott 32 HK$$$ Book now Apple wood Peking duck in a glamorous bank basement	**FITS** Wed 28 big dinner at 19:30. The pick for the best duck and the most theatre. Pre-order the duck when you book.

1.5 hrs	Ho Lee Fook HK$$ Book now Loud, fun modern Cantonese in SoHo	**FITS** Wed 28 big dinner if you want a party rather than polish. Right in SoHo, so the bars are steps away afterwards.
30 min	Lan Fong Yuen HK$ Walk-in Stocking strained milk tea and a pork chop bun	**FITS** Wed 28 at 14:00, right at the bottom of Graham Street Market as you arrive in Central. Or Thu 29 for a quick lunch. Closed Sundays, which is no problem for you.
45 min	Yat Lok HK$ Walk-in Michelin starred roast goose on noodles	**FITS** Thu 29 lunch in Central at 14:00, off the train from Tung Chung. Hong Kong Station to Stanley Street is about ten minutes' walk, and 14:00 misses the lunch rush.
20 min	Bakehouse HK$ Walk-in The city's best egg tart, sourdough crust, with coffee	**FITS** Thu 29 egg tart and coffee stop at 16:15. Up Hollywood Road from Man Mo Temple to Staunton Street, then down to the Star Ferry for 17:00. Takeaway, so eat it on the escalator steps.
1 hr	Hing Kee Restaurant HK$ Walk-in Cash Claypot rice on Temple Street, crisp crust and all	**FITS** Thu 29 Temple Street dinner at 19:30. Order the claypots first, they take 20 minutes, then browse the stalls after.
1.5 hrs	Maxim's Palace, City Hall HK$$ Book Old style yum cha with trolleys and harbour views	**FITS** Fri 30 yum cha at 12:30, the classic trolley option. Star Ferry across, then five minutes' walk. Call to book or arrive by 12:15. Back by Star Ferry for the spare window.
1.5 hrs	Spring Moon HK$$$ Book now Refined Michelin dim sum at The Peninsula	**FITS** Fri 30 yum cha at 12:30, the upscale option. Ten minutes' walk from the hotel, so no harbour crossing on your last day.
1 hr	Celestial Court HK$$ Book Dim sum on the 2nd floor of your own hotel	**FITS** Fri 30 yum cha at 12:30, the near TST option: zero travel, and the easy choice if the pool runs long. Also a fallback dinner on any night.
1 hr	Lei Garden, Elements HK$$ Book Cantonese roast meats in Elements, below Ozone	**FITS** Fri 30 dinner at 19:15, straight down from Ozone in the same building. Tell them you need to leave by 20:15 for the airport.
15 min	Mammy Pancake HK$ Walk-in Hot egg waffle from a Michelin street food counter	**FITS** Any afternoon or evening walk near the hotel. Good on Tue 27 after the promenade, or Fri 30 in the spare window.
45 min	Kam Wah Cafe HK$ Walk-in Pineapple bun with a slab of butter, the original	**FITS** Thu 29 after Temple Street for supper: two MTR stops north and open to 23:30. Or a breakfast swap for the lounge on Wed 28.

DRINK

1 hr	Bar Leone HK$$ Walk-in The World's Best Bar 2025, walk-in only	**FITS** Wed 28 bars in Central, after dinner. Expect to queue, it is part of the fun. Ten minutes' walk from SoHo or Central.
1 hr	Coa HK$$ Walk-in Award winning agave bar, tequila and mezcal	**FITS** Wed 28 bars in Central. Drop by at about 19:15 on the way to dinner to put your name on the waitlist, then come back after.
1 hr	Argo HK$$$ Book Harbour view cocktails at the Four Seasons	**FITS** Wed 28 if you want a seat and a view rather than a queue. Two minutes from the Star Ferry pier, so it works before the ferry home.

1 hr	DarkSide HK$$$ Book Dark spirits and live jazz at the Rosewood	**FITS** Tue 27 late, or Thu 29 at 21:30 instead of going straight back to the hotel. Ten minutes' walk along the waterfront.
VIEWS		
1 hr	Sky Lounge, Sheraton HK$$ Walk-in Harbour view bar at the top of your hotel	**FITS** Any evening at 20:00 for the light show, or a rainy afternoon. Handy on Fri 30 if Ozone is clouded in.
SIGHTS		
1.5 hrs	Hong Kong Museum of Art Free Chinese art with harbour windows, free entry	**FITS** Fri 30 spare window at 14:00, five minutes from the hotel. Closed Thursday.
2 hrs	Chi Lin Nunnery and Nan Lian Garden Free Timber nunnery and a Tang style garden	**FITS** Fri 30 spare window at 14:00, about 25 minutes by MTR. Go early in the window so the nunnery halls are still open.
SHOPPING		
1.5 hrs	Ladies' Market and Mong Kok Cash Street stalls, sneakers and the Goldfish Market	**FITS** Fri 30 spare window, or a swap for Temple Street on Thu 29 evening. Three MTR stops north.
NIGHT		
3 hrs	Hong Kong horse racing Floodlit Happy Valley racing, not on your dates.	**FITS** No Happy Valley meeting while you are here: Wed 28 racing is at Sha Tin, and the next Happy Valley meetings are Sun 1 and Wed 4 November.
FURTHER OUT		
3 hrs	Tai O Stilt house fishing village on Lantau	**FITS** Thu 29 after the Big Buddha, by bus instead of the cable car down. It costs Central lunch and Sheung Wan, so only if the Island day moves.
Full day	Lantau Island Mountains, beaches and the Big Buddha island.	**FITS** Already your Thu 29 morning. Tai O is the natural add-on.
3 to 4 hrs	Dragon's Back Free The ridge hike with sea on both sides.	**FITS** Fri 30 morning instead of the pool if the weather is clear. Start by 09:00 to be back by 16:15. Take water and sunscreen.
2 hrs	Shek O and Big Wave Bay Free Beach village at the end of the hike.	**FITS** Finish the Dragon's Back here for a swim and a seafood lunch, then bus back to Shau Kei Wan.
MASSAGE		
1 hr	Kungfu head therapy Book Head therapy, two minutes from the hotel.	**FITS** 11:00 to 22:00. Book by message.
1 hr	Foot Lam Moon Foot Reflexology Foot reflexology on Hankow Road.	**FITS** 10:00 to 00:30, so it works after dinner.
1 hr	Fu Ying Massage Foot and body massage on Granville Road.	**FITS** Open 24 hours. Good on Fri 30 after checkout while you wait for the airport.